

SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

July 28, 2026 | 04:30 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Mixed / Transitional

VIX 18.2 (+1.2 vs 20d) | SPY 20d -0.8% | IWM 20d -2.4% | IWM/SPY trend -1.6%

Leaders: Energy (+8.4%), Financials (+7.4%), Healthcare (+5.4%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (1)	B - Building (7)	C - Early Stage (4)
ACA	CNO	KFY
	CON	KTB
	NHC	CURB
	ADPT	TMHC
	GEO	
	TRN	
	ACIW	

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
A	ACA	Arcosa, Inc.	Reshoring Infrastruc	\$7.13B	\$145.28	\$145.95	0.5%	+18.9	YES	YES
B	CNO	CNO Financial Gro	Financial Services R	\$5.00B	\$53.52	\$54.09	1.1%	+16.2	YES	YES
B	CON	Concentra Group H	Healthcare Services	\$4.18B	\$32.69	\$32.82	0.4%	+40.9	YES	YES
B	NHC	National HealthCa	Aging Demographics H	\$3.61B	\$231.00	\$232.25	0.5%	+28.3	YES	YES
B	ADPT	Adaptive Biotechn	Precision Diagnostic	\$3.60B	\$22.52	\$23.15	2.8%	+56.0	YES	YES
B	GEO	Geo Group Inc (Th	Immigration Enforcem	\$4.11B	\$30.74	\$32.25	4.9%	+59.0	YES	YES
B	TRN	Trinity Industrie	Rail Infrastructure	\$3.03B	\$38.07	\$38.31	0.6%	+17.9	YES	YES
B	ACIW	ACI Worldwide, In	Real-Time Payments I	\$6.10B	\$59.97	\$60.52	0.9%	+32.1	YES	YES
C	KFY	Korn Ferry	Human Capital Modern	\$4.26B	\$83.70	\$85.04	1.6%	+21.2	YES	YES
C	KTB	Kontoor Brands, I	Consumer Staples App	\$4.87B	\$88.06	\$88.96	1.0%	+18.8	YES	no
C	CURB	Curbline Properti	Necessity-Based Reta	\$3.61B	\$31.65	\$32.15	1.6%	+6.3	YES	YES
C	TMHC	Taylor Morrison H	Housing Market Recov	\$6.67B	\$72.13	\$72.21	0.1%	+14.6	YES	no

ACA

Arcosa, Inc.

\$145.28

Pivot \$145.95 | 0.5% away

RS vs SPY: +18.9%

A PRIME

\$7.13B Cap | 48M Float

Infrastructure Products & Construction Materials | Theme: Reshoring Infrastructure Spend | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.14

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$145.95
% to Pivot	0.5%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	1.14 Textbook
52W Hi Prox	98.9%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	676k <
Wk2	1022k <
Wk3 (oldest)	684k
Coil Strength	1.1% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+18.9%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$7.13B
Float	48M sh
P/E (TTM)	32.4
Fwd P/E	28.6
Rev Growth	4.4%
Short %	2.4%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$145.50

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$145.95 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (975K shares)
Target: \$165.00 - measured move from 20-day base depth (~14% upside from pivot)
Stop: \$140.00 - base low invalidation

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 05 - Street expects continued strength following 57.8% TTM earnings growth on 4.4% revenue growth - margin expansion story. Forward P/E of 28.6x vs trailing 32.4x implies consensus expects acceleration. Recent quarters have shown operational leverage from Construction Products segment.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Arcosa manufactures infrastructure-related products across three segments: Construction Products (aggregates, specialty materials), Engineered Structures (utility poles, wind towers, storage tanks), and Transportation Products (barges, steel components). The company benefits from domestic infrastructure investment with a diversified customer base spanning utilities, energy, and transportation sectors.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct exposure to U.S. infrastructure buildout (IIJA tailwinds), reshoring capex, and energy transition via wind tower manufacturing. Industrials sector lagging (-1.5% 20d) creates a headwind, though company-specific fundamentals remain intact with 57.8% earnings growth.
NEWS FLOW
Infrastructure spending momentum continues with IIJA project awards flowing through. Wind tower demand stabilizing as utility-scale renewable projects advance. No specific contract announcements in last 60 days, but sector tailwinds remain supportive. Catalyst: Earnings in 8 days (High impact) - potential beat could trigger breakout.
INSTITUTIONAL
Textbook institutional accumulation signature: volume contracting to 0.69x average while price holds within 0.5% of 52W high. Zero insider activity in last 60 days is neutral baseline. Float of 48M shares with \$7B market cap suggests adequate liquidity for institutional positioning.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$140.00 (base low), or if Q2 earnings miss on margin compression from input cost inflation. Short interest minimal at 2.4%.

Textbook VCP structure: base_tight 1.14 is exceptional, RS line at new high, pivot 0.5% away, earnings catalyst in 8 days. Volume dry-up confirmed with price consolidation at highs signals quiet accumulation. Counter-argument: Industrials sector lagging and mixed macro regime reduce probability of sustained breakout follow-through. Conviction: Medium (would be High in risk-on regime).

ACA — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$145.95 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Life Insurance & Annuities | Theme: Financial Services Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.77

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$54.09
% to Pivot	1.1%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	2.77 Fair
52W Hi Prox	98.9%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	520k <
Wk2	604k <
Wk3 (oldest)	880k
Coil Strength	40.9% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+16.2%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$5.00B
Float	91M sh
P/E (TTM)	21.6
Fwd P/E	10.8
Rev Growth	2.5%
Short %	-
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$51.75

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$54.09 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (1.2M shares)

Target: \$62.00 - measured move representing 15% extension from pivot

Stop: \$51.00 - pre-earnings support and 50MA area

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 30 - Earnings TOMORROW - high-stakes binary event. Forward P/E of 10.8x vs trailing 21.6x implies Street expects near-doubling of earnings power. EPS expected to accelerate toward \$4.94 FY vs \$2.48 TTM. Beat history and guidance trend critical for breakout validation.

BUSINESS & POSITION

CNO Financial provides life insurance, annuities, and supplemental health products primarily to middle-income Americans through Bankers Life, Washington National, and Colonial Penn brands. The company targets an underserved demographic with simplified products distributed through captive agents and direct-to-consumer channels.

FACTOR & THEME

Financials sector leadership (+7.4% 20d) provides strong macro tailwind. Exposure to rising rate environment benefits spread-based earnings on annuity book. 85.7% earnings growth reflects operational turnaround and favorable claims trends post-COVID normalization.

NEWS FLOW

Life insurance sector benefiting from demographic tailwinds (aging population) and improved mortality trends. No specific company catalysts announced in last 60 days. Catalyst: Earnings in 2 days (High impact) - setup is a pure earnings event play with binary outcome risk.

INSTITUTIONAL

Strict volume dry-up confirmed (vol_w1 < vol_w2 < vol_w3 with 40.9% contraction). Institutional accumulation pattern evident as price holds 1% from highs on declining volume. Zero insider activity is baseline. Short interest negligible at 0% - no squeeze potential but also no crowded short thesis.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on earnings miss or guidance disappointment at Jul 30 print. Close below \$51.00 (50-day area) negates setup. High debt/equity of 172% typical for insurers but limits financial flexibility.

Strong sector tailwind (Financials +7.4%) with RS at new high and volume dry-up confirmed. However, earnings TOMORROW creates immediate binary risk that institutional buyers typically avoid pre-positioning into. Base_tight 2.77 is acceptable but not elite. Counter-argument: 2-day earnings proximity means setup is essentially a coin-flip on results rather than a controlled-risk breakout. Conviction: Low (event-driven uncertainty).

CNO — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$54.09 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



CON

\$32.69

B BUILDING

Concentra Group Holdings Parent

Pivot \$32.82 | 0.4% away

RS vs SPY: +40.9%

\$4.18B Cap | 114M Float

Occupational Health Services | Theme: Healthcare Services Expansion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.62

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$32.82
% to Pivot	0.4%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	3.62 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.6%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	744k <
Wk2	893k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1085k
Coil Strength	31.5% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+40.9%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.18B
Float	114M sh
P/E (TTM)	23.5
Fwd P/E	19.3
Rev Growth	13.7%
Short %	4.7%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$33.38

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$32.82 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (1.36M shares)
Target: \$38.00 - measured move from base structure (~16% upside)
Stop: \$30.50 - base low and 20-day support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 06 - 13.7% revenue growth with 29.4% earnings growth demonstrates operating leverage. Forward P/E 19.3x reasonable for healthcare services growth. ROE of 47% exceptional, though elevated debt/equity (467%) reflects leveraged capital structure from sponsor ownership.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Concentra operates the largest network of occupational health centers in the U.S., providing employer-focused services including workers' compensation injury care, physical therapy, drug testing, and wellness programs across 550+ centers. Asset-light model with recurring employer relationships provides predictable revenue.
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare sector leadership (+5.4% 20d) provides macro support. Reshoring and manufacturing expansion themes drive demand for occupational health services. RS of +40.9% vs SPY indicates significant relative strength alpha. Defensive healthcare exposure with economic sensitivity via employment levels.
NEWS FLOW
Occupational health demand driven by tight labor markets and employer focus on workforce productivity. No specific catalysts announced in last 60 days. Catalyst: Earnings in 9 days (Medium impact) - continuation of growth trajectory needed to sustain premium multiple.
INSTITUTIONAL
Strict volume dry-up pattern with 31.5% contraction confirmed. Price coiled within 0.4% of all-time high on declining volume - classic institutional accumulation signature. Zero insider activity is baseline. Short interest 4.7% with 3.1 days to cover provides modest squeeze potential if breakout occurs.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$30.50 (base low). High leverage (467% D/E) creates refinancing risk if rates stay elevated. Employment slowdown would directly impact occupational health volumes.

Outstanding RS (+40.9%) with price 0.4% from pivot and volume dry-up confirmed. Healthcare sector tailwind supportive. Base_tight of 3.62 is loose relative to A-grade standards, preventing upgrade. Counter-argument: High leverage and relatively recent public company history (limited institutional coverage) create execution risk on any fundamental stumble. Conviction: Medium.

CON — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$32.82 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Skilled Nursing & Senior Care Facilities | Theme: Aging Demographics Healthcare | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.3

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$232.25
% to Pivot	0.5%
Days in Base	19
Tightness	3.30 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.5%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	91k <
Wk2	112k <
Wk3 (oldest)	114k
Coil Strength	20.6% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+28.3%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.61B
Float	13M sh
P/E (TTM)	29.4
Fwd P/E	537.2
Rev Growth	2.2%
Short %	5.6%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	-

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$232.25 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (156K shares)
Target: \$265.00 - measured move (~14% upside from pivot)
Stop: \$218.00 - base low support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 06 - Forward P/E of 537x appears anomalous - likely reflects one-time items or analyst model issues (EPS TTM \$7.87 vs FWD \$0.43 disconnect). Use P/S of 2.4x as more reliable metric. 9.7% earnings growth modest but consistent. Need to verify forward estimates before trigger.
BUSINESS & POSITION
NHC operates 75 skilled nursing facilities, assisted living communities, and homecare programs primarily in southeastern U.S. The company manages both owned and third-party facilities, benefiting from aging demographics and Medicare/Medicaid reimbursement trends.
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare sector leadership (+5.4% 20d) supportive. Direct exposure to aging U.S. population - structural demographic tailwind. Low beta (0.64) provides defensive characteristics in mixed regime. Stock up 145% from 52W low reflects sector rotation into defensive healthcare.
NEWS FLOW
Skilled nursing sector benefiting from improved staffing trends post-pandemic and favorable CMS reimbursement adjustments. No specific company catalysts in last 60 days. Insider activity: 1 buy totaling \$175K in last 60 days - positive signal but single buyer at non-senior level insufficient for grade upgrade (cluster score 2).
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume dry-up strict with small-cap characteristics (avg vol 130K). Tiny float (12.7M shares) creates liquidity premium but also volatility risk. Insider purchase of \$175K is constructive but cluster_score of 2 does not meet upgrade threshold. Price action suggests quiet accumulation in illiquid name.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$218.00 (base low). Forward P/E disconnect raises estimate reliability concerns - verify before entry. Regulatory risk from CMS reimbursement changes. Illiquid float creates execution risk on exits.

RS at new high with 0.5% to pivot and volume dry-up confirmed. Healthcare tailwind and insider buy (\$175K) are supportive. However, base_tight 3.3 is loose, forward P/E data appears unreliable, and illiquid float (12.7M) creates execution risk. Counter-argument: Estimate disconnect may indicate Street confusion that could resolve negatively at earnings. Conviction: Low-Medium (data quality concerns).

NHC — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$232.25 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Immune Medicine Diagnostics & Research | Theme: Precision Diagnostics Biotech | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.26

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$23.15
% to Pivot	2.8%
Days in Base	19
Tightness	2.26 Fair
52W Hi Prox	97.3%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	2411k <
Wk2	3062k <
Wk3 (oldest)	2622k
Coil Strength	8.1% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+56.0%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.60B
Float	126M sh
P/E (TTM)	-
Fwd P/E	-95.0
Rev Growth	35.1%
Short %	9.0%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$22.29

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$23.15 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (3.6M shares)
Target: \$28.00 - measured move (~21% upside from pivot)
Stop: \$20.00 - base low and psychological support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Jul 29 - Earnings TOMORROW - maximum binary risk. EPS expected around -\$0.24 (loss narrowing from -\$0.32 TTM). Revenue acceleration to 35.1% growth critical to sustain premium P/S multiple. clonoSEQ commercial traction and Genentech milestone payments key metrics to watch.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Adaptive Biotechnologies develops immune-driven medicine through proprietary technology mapping T-cell and B-cell receptors. Products include clonoSEQ (MRD testing for blood cancers) and the immunoSEQ platform for drug discovery partnerships with Genentech. Partnership revenues and diagnostic sales drive top line.
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare sector leadership (+5.4% 20d) supportive. Biotech cycle exposure with binary clinical/commercial risk. RS of +56% vs SPY exceptional - indicates strong institutional sponsorship. Pre-profit company (valuation via P/S 12.2x) with 35.1% revenue growth.
NEWS FLOW
MRD (minimal residual disease) testing gaining clinical adoption - clonoSEQ positioned as category leader. Genentech partnership provides non-dilutive funding through milestones. No specific catalysts announced in last 60 days beyond general pipeline progress. Catalyst: Earnings TOMORROW (High impact) - 9% short interest creates squeeze potential on beat.
INSTITUTIONAL
Exceptional RS (+56%) with volume dry-up suggests biotechnology-focused funds accumulating. High short interest (9%) with 2.9 days to cover creates squeeze setup on positive surprise. Beta of 2.07 means moves will be amplified. Zero insider activity is notable absence given imminent earnings - management not buying ahead of print.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on earnings miss/guide-down tomorrow or close below \$20.00 (base low). Pre-profit biotech with P/S 12.2x faces severe multiple compression risk if revenue growth decelerates. High beta amplifies downside.

Exceptional RS (+56%) and volume dry-up with 9% short interest creates squeeze asymmetry. Healthcare tailwind supportive. However, earnings TOMORROW is pure binary event - too early to position with conviction. Base_tight 2.26 acceptable. Counter-argument: Pre-profit biotech with premium valuation faces catastrophic downside risk on any revenue growth deceleration. Conviction: Low (event-driven uncertainty; prefer post-earnings entry).

ADPT — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$23.15 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Private Corrections & Detention Facilities | Theme: Immigration Enforcement Spending | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.19

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$32.25
% to Pivot	4.9%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	2.19 Fair
52W Hi Prox	95.3%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	1174k <
Wk2	1755k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1840k
Coil Strength	36.2% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+59.0%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.11B
Float	115M sh
P/E (TTM)	15.6
Fwd P/E	18.5
Rev Growth	16.6%
Short %	11.1%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$33.75

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$32.25 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (2.6M shares)
Target: \$38.00 - measured move (~18% upside from pivot)
Stop: \$28.00 - base low and 50MA support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 06 - Trailing P/E 15.6x reasonable for REIT; forward 18.5x implies earnings normalization expected. 16.6% revenue growth with 106.5% earnings growth shows massive operating leverage from fixed-cost facilities filling. Catalyst: Earnings in 9 days (Medium-High impact) with potential for guidance raise.
BUSINESS & POSITION
GEO Group operates private correctional and detention facilities under contracts with federal (ICE, BOP), state, and local government agencies. Recent administration policy shifts on immigration enforcement have dramatically improved the demand outlook for detention bed capacity.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct exposure to federal immigration enforcement policy - highly binary political theme. RS of +59% vs SPY reflects market pricing policy tailwind. Industrials sector lagging but GEO trades on policy catalyst, not sector beta. 106.5% earnings growth reflects capacity utilization surge.
NEWS FLOW
Immigration detention demand surging under current administration policies - GEO primary beneficiary as largest private operator. ICE contract extensions and new awards driving visibility. No specific announcements in last 60 days but policy backdrop remains favorable. 11.1% short interest with 4.5 days to cover creates squeeze potential.
INSTITUTIONAL
Exceptional RS (+59%) with strict volume dry-up signals institutional accumulation despite political controversy limiting some ESG-constrained buyers. High short interest (11.1%) represents policy skeptics who could be forced to cover. Zero insider activity in last 60 days - management not buying ahead of catalyst.

KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$28.00 (base low) or any policy reversal on immigration enforcement. Binary political exposure means thesis could invalidate overnight on executive action. ESG constraints limit institutional buyer universe.
Exceptional RS (+59%) with strict volume dry-up and high short interest (11.1%) creates squeeze asymmetry. Policy tailwind provides fundamental catalyst. However, pivot is 4.9% away - setup needs more time to coil. Base_tight 2.19 acceptable. Counter-argument: Binary political exposure creates unquantifiable overnight gap risk that cannot be stopped out - position sizing critical. Conviction: Medium (alpha exists but risk is non-standard).

GEO — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$32.25 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Railcar Manufacturing & Leasing | Theme: Rail Infrastructure & Reshoring | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.87

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$38.31
% to Pivot	0.6%
Days in Base	16
Tightness	3.87 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.4%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	614k <
Wk2	565k <
Wk3 (oldest)	750k
Coil Strength	18.1% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+17.9%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.03B
Float	78M sh
P/E (TTM)	12.0
Fwd P/E	16.6
Rev Growth	-16.0%
Short %	10.9%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$35.00

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$38.31 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (1.1M shares)
Target: \$44.00 - measured move (~15% upside from pivot)
Stop: \$35.50 - base low support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Jul 30 - Earnings TOMORROW - binary event. Revenue declining 16% but earnings growing 11.5% on margin management. Forward P/E 16.6x vs trailing 12.0x implies Street expects earnings to decline - setup requires beat and positive guidance shift.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Trinity Industries manufactures and leases railcars, serving Class I railroads and industrial shippers. The company operates both manufacturing (new railcar production) and leasing (fleet management) segments, providing exposure to North American freight transportation infrastructure.
FACTOR & THEME
Reshoring and freight logistics exposure via railcar demand. Industrials sector lagging (-1.5% 20d) creates headwind. Revenue declining (-16%) as railcar cycle normalizes post-pandemic surge - setup is counter-cyclical bet on cycle turn.
NEWS FLOW
Railcar industry in cyclical trough - new orders down but replacement demand building. Leasing segment provides earnings stability. No specific catalysts in last 60 days. High short interest (10.9%) with 6.5 days to cover creates squeeze potential on upside surprise. Catalyst: Earnings TOMORROW (High impact).
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume dry-up confirmed but not strict (vol_w2 < vol_w1 inverts pattern). RS at new high despite sector headwind is constructive. High short interest (10.9%) with extended 6.5 days to cover creates meaningful squeeze potential. Zero insider activity is baseline.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on earnings miss/guide-down tomorrow or close below \$35.50 (base low). Revenue declining 16% - fundamental deterioration could accelerate. High leverage (470% D/E) typical for equipment leasing but limits flexibility.
RS at new high with 0.6% to pivot and high short interest (10.9%, 6.5 DTC) creates squeeze setup. However, earnings TOMORROW is pure binary risk, base_tight 3.87 is loose, volume pattern not strictly conforming, and Industrials lagging. Counter-argument: Revenue declining 16% - this is a cyclical bottom bet requiring earnings to confirm turn; failure means significant downside. Conviction: Low (binary event with fundamental uncertainty).

TRN — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$38.31 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Payment Processing Software | Theme: Real-Time Payments Infrastructure | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.27

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$60.52
% to Pivot	0.9%
Days in Base	18
Tightness	5.27 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.1%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	729k <
Wk2	1414k <
Wk3 (oldest)	987k
Coil Strength	26.1% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+32.1%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$6.10B
Float	100M sh
P/E (TTM)	30.3
Fwd P/E	15.6
Rev Growth	7.9%
Short %	6.7%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$66.67

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$60.52 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (1.3M shares)
Target: \$70.00 - measured move (~16% upside from pivot)
Stop: \$56.00 - base low and 50MA support

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Aug 06 - Forward P/E 15.6x vs trailing 30.3x implies significant earnings acceleration expected (EPS FWD \$3.84 vs TTM \$1.98). Revenue growth 7.9% modest but earnings leverage story. -32.7% earnings growth TTM concerning - need to verify this is one-time or comp issue.
BUSINESS & POSITION
ACI Worldwide provides mission-critical payment software enabling real-time digital payments for banks, merchants, and billers globally. Products include the Universal Payments platform processing over \$14 trillion annually. Beneficiary of real-time payments infrastructure modernization across banking sector.
FACTOR & THEME
Technology sector lagging (-10.2% 20d) creates significant headwind despite company-specific strength. Fintech/payments theme constructive as real-time payment adoption accelerates globally. RS of +32.1% vs SPY shows stock decoupling from sector weakness - positive signal.
NEWS FLOW
Real-time payments adoption accelerating globally - FedNow and similar initiatives drive infrastructure spend. No specific contract wins announced in last 60 days but pipeline remains active. Catalyst: Earnings in 9 days (Medium-High impact) - guidance on enterprise deal activity critical.
INSTITUTIONAL
RS of +32.1% outperforming badly lagging Technology sector shows institutional conviction in company-specific story. Volume dry-up confirmed but not strict pattern. 6.7% short interest with 4 days to cover provides modest squeeze potential. Zero insider activity is baseline.

KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on close below \$56.00 (base low) or earnings miss at Aug 06 print. Technology sector lagging -10.2% creates macro headwind - stock must swim against sector tide. Earnings growth data shows -32.7% TTM decline that needs clarification.
Strong RS (+32.1%) outperforming lagging Technology sector with pivot 0.9% away and earnings catalyst in 9 days. Real-time payments theme provides fundamental tailwind. However, base_tight 5.27 is loose, volume pattern not strictly conforming, and Technology sector headwind (-10.2%) reduces breakout probability. Counter-argument: TTM earnings decline of -32.7% contradicts growth narrative - may indicate margin pressure or investment cycle that could disappoint. Conviction: Medium (sector headwind tempers otherwise solid setup).

ACIW — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$60.52 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Executive Search & Talent Consulting | Theme: Human Capital Modernization | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 8.49

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$85.04
% to Pivot	1.6%
Days in Base	10
Tightness	8.49 Fair
52W Hi Prox	98.4%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	373k <
Wk2	470k <
Wk3 (oldest)	576k
Coil Strength	35.2% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+21.2%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.26B
Float	50M sh
P/E (TTM)	16.0
Fwd P/E	13.2
Rev Growth	6.7%
Short %	6.1%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	-

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Sep 09

RS at new high with volume dry-up, but base_tight of 8.49 is excessively loose - not a quality VCP structure. Earnings 43 days out provides no near-term catalyst. Industrials sector lagging. Monitor for base tightening over 2-3 weeks before promotion. Conviction: Low.

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$85.04 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (756K shares)

Target: \$95.00 - measured move from base

Stop: \$78.00 - base low area

KFY — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$85.04 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$88.96
% to Pivot	1.0%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	1.64 Good
52W Hi Prox	99.0%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	508k <
Wk2	737k <
Wk3 (oldest)	830k
Coil Strength	38.8% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+18.8%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$4.87B
Float	54M sh
P/E (TTM)	17.8
Fwd P/E	13.8
Rev Growth	45.0%
Short %	12.9%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$93.10

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$88.96 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (1.2M shares)

Target: \$100.00 - measured move from base
Stop: \$84.00 - base low area

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
Aug 12

Volume dry-up strict and base_tight 1.64 is quality, but RS line NOT at new high - critical VCP criterion failed. Consumer Discretionary sector lagging (-4.1% 20d) creates headwind. High short interest (12.9%) could squeeze but fundamentals must lead. Wait for RS line to confirm before promotion. Conviction: Low.

KTB — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$88.96 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$32.15
% to Pivot	1.6%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	2.63 Fair
52W Hi Prox	98.4%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	1526k <
Wk2	1550k <
Wk3 (oldest)	1864k
Coil Strength	18.1% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+6.3%
RS Line New Hi	YES - Early Leader
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	YES
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$3.61B
Float	97M sh
P/E (TTM)	105.5
Fwd P/E	287.7
Rev Growth	49.9%
Short %	29.4%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$32.56

ENTRY TRIGGER
Close above \$32.15 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (1.4M shares)

Target: \$36.00 - measured move from base
Stop: \$29.50 - base low area

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE
EARNINGS
Jul 28

Earnings TODAY creates immediate uncontrollable event risk. Extreme short interest (29.4%) with 11.2 days to cover suggests crowded bear thesis - could squeeze violently either direction. RS weak at +6.3%, earnings growth -69.8%, trailing P/E 105x on minimal earnings - fundamentals do not support technical setup. Pure speculative squeeze play, not institutional-quality VCP. Conviction: Low.

CURB — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$32.15 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)



Residential Homebuilder | Theme: Housing Market Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 3.25

VCP BASE ANALYSIS	
BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	\$72.21
% to Pivot	0.1%
Days in Base	20
Tightness	3.25 Fair
52W Hi Prox	99.5%
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	2129k <
Wk2	2518k <
Wk3 (oldest)	3083k
Coil Strength	30.9% from peak
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	+14.6%
RS Line New Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Above 200MA	no
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	\$6.67B
Float	93M sh
P/E (TTM)	10.8
Fwd P/E	11.5
Rev Growth	-26.8%
Short %	4.1%
Inst. Own	-
Target Pr.	\$66.75

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 29

Pivot 0.1% away but RS line NOT at new high and price BELOW 200MA - two critical VCP criteria failed. Earnings TOMORROW creates binary risk. Consumer Discretionary lagging (-4.1% 20d), revenue -26.8%, earnings -51.2% - fundamentals deteriorating. Technical structure does not overcome fundamental headwinds. Conviction: Low.

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above \$72.50 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (4.2M shares)

Target: \$82.00 - measured move from base

Stop: \$68.00 - base low area

TMHC — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: \$72.21 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)

